MONTHLY UPDATE

Ethiopia: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Regional collaboration · Standards · Public debate and participation in policymaking

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity · Energy · Cybersecurity

DPI
Data Exchange · Digital Identity and CRVS · Digital Payments and Fintech · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

INCLUSION
Access to services

GEOPOLITICS
India activities

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

NATIONAL FINANCIAL INCLUSION STRATEGY III (2026-2030)

- **High Digital Transaction Costs, Fraud Gaps Threaten Ethiopia's Financial Inclusion Targets: Report** — The Reporter, 3 October 2026

  An assessment of Ethiopia's second financial inclusion strategy found adult account ownership at 66 per cent in 2025 against a 70 per cent target, with some banks charging up to 11 per cent for transfers to mobile wallets. Only 29.56 per cent of 157.6 million mobile money accounts were active in June 2026; a third strategy, for 2026 to 2030, was launched alongside it.

Legislation and regulation

NATIONAL DATA MANAGEMENT PROCLAMATION (DRAFT)

- **Council of Ministers Refers Key Bills to HPR on Governance, Data, Power and Defense** — Ethiopian News Agency (ENA), 28 September 2026

  The state news agency's account of the same Council session names the bill the National Data Governance Draft Proclamation, referred to parliament with the Council's unanimous backing.

- **Ethiopia's Council of Ministers Advances New Legal Frameworks for State Institutions, Data Sovereignty, Defence and Economy** — Fana Media Corporation S.C., 28 September 2026

> Ethiopia's Council of Ministers unanimously sent a draft national data proclamation to parliament, framed around data security and sovereignty, data sharing and interoperability across government, and support for AI research.

Regional collaboration

> HORIZON FIBER TERRESTRIAL CORRIDOR

- **Projet de fibre optique « Horizon » : Une nouvelle autoroute numérique pour la Corne de l'Afrique** — La Nation, 9 September 2026 DJIBOUTI SUDAN

  Addis Ababa meeting pitches the Djibouti-Ethiopia-Sudan corridor to Google, Meta, Microsoft, Amazon and carriers.

Standards

> CENTRAL BANK DIRECTIVE ON MICROFINANCE DIGITAL READINESS (MFI/33/2022)

- **When Digital Ambition Becomes a Tripping Stone** — Capital (Ethiopia), 6 September 2026

  Practitioner case that NBE Directive MFI/33/2022 already defines the readiness MFIs skip when they buy wallets first.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

> COMMUNICATIONS DISRUPTION IN TIGRAY

- **Tigray Cut Off Again as Communications Blackout Deepens Civilian Misery** — WardheerNews, 26 September 2026

  Ethio Telecom down, Safaricom partly up as fighting resumes; cash-short region loses mobile money; blame contested.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

> NEXT HORIZON: DIGITAL & BEYOND 2028 STRATEGY

- **Ethio Telecom Announces Successful Completion of First Year of Next Horizon Strategy** — Ethiopian News Agency (ENA), 3 September 2026

  Year one of Next Horizon: about 90m customers, telebirr near 61m, 4G population coverage 82.23%.

- **Ethio telecom Next Horizon - Digital & Beyond Strategy 2028 Year II 2019 EFY (2026/27) Annual Business Plan** — Ethio telecom, 3 September 2026

  ETB 295bn revenue target, 96.2m customers, 4G to 11,014 sites; the operator's own Year II plan in full.

- **Ethio Telecom to Expand 4G Network to 11,014 Sites in 2026/27** — Tech Africa News, 9 September 2026

  Ethio Telecom is to expand its 4G network from 6,924 to 11,014 sites in 2026/27 under the Year II plan of its Next Horizon strategy. It is a published target, not an outturn.

> ETHIO TELECOM NETWORK

- **Ethio Telecom Targets 96.2 Million Customers, ETB 295 Billion Revenue in 2026/27** — TechAfrica News, 4 September 2026

Ethio Telecom set 2026/27 targets of 96.2 million customers and ETB 295 billion revenue in its annual business plan, the second year of its Next Horizon strategy. The plan raises 4G capacity from 22.79 million to 35.31 million subscribers and 4G population coverage from 82.23% to 95%, 5G sites from 340 to 648 and 5G towns from 33 to 73, backbone fibre from 23,442 km to 25,642 km and gateway capacity from 4.3 Tbps to 5.2 Tbps, with telebirr targeted at 67.69 million customers.

SAFARICOM ETHIOPIA SECOND NETWORK

- **Safaricom Ethiopia Surpasses 15 Million Subscribers After Four Years of Operations** — TechAfrica News, 4 September 2026

  Safaricom Ethiopia passed 15 million 90-day active subscribers in under four years of commercial operation, marking five years since its unified licence of 9 July 2021. It has deployed more than 3,500 network sites, all 4G-enabled and 5G-ready, reaching about 60% of the population, and says the growing base is moving the business towards breakeven; it puts community investment at ETB 684 million over four years.

- **Safaricom Ethiopia Engages Government on Network Expansion and Digital Transformation** — Tech Africa News, 9 September 2026

  Safaricom Ethiopia put itself at 15 million 90-day active customers and more than 3,600 sites in five years of operation, at a meeting with the innovation and technology minister. Its chief executive raised infrastructure and supply-chain constraints on further rollout, including the timely customs clearance of telecommunications equipment and fibre cable.

- **Safaricom Ethiopia passes 15 million subscribers five years after getting its licence** — Tech-ish, 14 September 2026

  15 million 90-day active subscribers announced 2026-09-03, five years after the 2021 licence.

Energy

BITDEER OROMIA BITCOIN-MINING SITE

- **Ethiopia Sacrifices Lucrative Bitcoin Mining Revenue as Hydropower Crisis Deepens** — Norvanreports, 15 September 2026

  The state power utility cut supply to bitcoin mining and data-mining operations as a hydropower shortfall deepened, giving up the revenue that load was earning.

Cybersecurity

FINANCIAL SECTOR CYBERSECURITY FORUM

- **Ethiopia establishes financial sector cybersecurity forum to improve digital resilience** — Tech Review Africa, 30 September 2026

  Ethiopia set up a Financial Sector Cybersecurity Forum on 29 September, chaired jointly by the cyber agency INSA and the National Bank, for threat sharing and coordinated incident response across financial institutions.

DPI

Data Exchange

AFRICA ACCELERATOR FOR DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE (AA4DPI)

- **CDPI on its session at the Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, 2–3 September 2026** — Centre for Digital Public Infrastructure (CDPI), 3 September 2026 MALAWI RWANDA SIERRA LEONE ZAMBIA

Two-day accelerator session, 2–3 Sept 2026: delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone, Zambia.

- **Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure (AA4DPI)** — United Nations Development Programme, 8 September 2026 AFRICA

  UNDP has published the standing description of its Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, led jointly by the Regional Bureau for Africa and the Digital and AI Hub, which supports countries to assess digital readiness, strengthen governance, build implementation capacity and develop investment-ready programmes across digital identity, digital payments and data exchange. Its first published cohort session ran on 2 and 3 September with delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia; no budget, duration or deliverable set is published for the accelerator itself.

- **UNDP's AA4DPI Programme Deepens South-South Cooperation on Digital Public Infrastructure** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), 8 September 2026 MALAWI RWANDA SIERRA LEONE ZAMBIA AFRICA

  Delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia, with African Union representatives, concluded a two-week South-South learning mission to India on digital public infrastructure. Convened under UNDP's newly launched Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, it took delegates through New Delhi, Pune and Bengaluru to examine India's digital identity, payment and data exchange systems.

Digital Identity and CRVS

FAYDA NATIONAL DIGITAL IDENTITY

- **Ethiopia Announces Document Requirements for Foreign Nationals Applying for Fayda Digital ID** — Ethio Affairs, 4 September 2026

  Passport plus residence permit, refugee ID or investment licence: what non-Ethiopians must show to enrol.

- **Fayda — 33 Proof of Acceptable Documents** — National ID Program (NIDP), Ethiopia, 7 September 2026

  The national identity programme's own page lists the 33 documents accepted as proof of identity for registration, from the local administration card and passport to birth, education, marriage and business records. The page carries no publication date of its own.

- **Ethiopia launches developer sandbox to support Fayda digital ID innovation, integration** — Biometric Update, 9 October 2026

  Ethiopia opened a public sandbox where developers and startups can test the Fayda digital identity's authentication interfaces before going live. Fayda counted more than 52 million registrations, 150 integrated partners and 208 million electronic verifications.

FAYDAVERSE DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE ENTERPRISE

- **Banks Baulk at a Bill from Public ID That Turns Commercial** — Addis Fortune, 3 October 2026

  Per-check KYC fees of 10-40 Br, no pass-through to customers, failed attempts billed; banks seek NBE-joint consultation.

Digital Payments and Fintech

M-PESA ETHIOPIA CARDLESS ATM WITHDRAWALS

- **M-PESA Ethiopia Expands Cardless ATM Withdrawals Through Awash Bank Partnership** — Tech Africa News, 8 September 2026

M-PESA Ethiopia has extended cardless ATM withdrawals to Awash Bank's machines, letting wallet holders draw cash without a bank card by authorising the withdrawal in the app. The service has been live with Bank of Abyssinia since August; the date it started with Awash Bank is not stated.

MOBILE MONEY WALLETS OPENED AGAINST ADULTS HOLDING AN ACCOUNT

- **Mobile Money in Ethiopia - A Diagnostic Report** — DFS Ethiopia Hub (Team Shega), 9 September 2026

  135m wallets opened, yet under 1 in 10 adults holds a mobile money account and 0.4% rely on one alone.

- **High Digital Transaction Costs, Fraud Gaps Threaten Ethiopia's Financial Inclusion Targets: Report** — The Reporter, 3 October 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

ETHIOPAY NATIONAL INSTANT PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **EthSwitch takes Ethiopia's digital payments push to global fintech stage** — TechReviewAfrica, 10 September 2026

  EthioPay's one-million-transaction day and ISO 20022 rails set against India's UPI expansion.

MANDATORY FAYDA INTEGRATION WITH BANK ACCOUNTS

- **CBE Gives Customers Until November 9 to Link Bank Accounts with Fayda ID** — Birr Metrics, 16 September 2026

  Branches outside Addis, Dire Dawa, Harari and 24 cities: link by 9 November or face debit restrictions.

PAN-AFRICAN PAYMENT AND SETTLEMENT SYSTEM MEMBERSHIP

- **Ethiopia Joins PAPSS in Major Step Towards Pan-African Payments** — FSX Business, 30 September 2026

  31st member country; four banks await NBE no-objection; PAPSS targets half of Ethiopia's banks by March 2027.

- **Mobile money wallets set to link with PAPSS, opening access to African markets** — Capital Newspaper, 4 October 2026

  Ethiopia's non-bank mobile-money operators and payment-service providers are preparing to connect to the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System. Each needs a letter of no objection from the National Bank of Ethiopia first, and operators are weighing a direct connection against routing through EthSwitch or partner banks.

UNIFIED GOVERNMENT PAYMENT PLATFORM

- **EthSwitch Unveils Unified Government Payment Platform** — Tech Africa News, 1 October 2026

  Ethiopia's national payment switch presented a unified government payment platform at the Ethiopia Finance Forum. It would give government bill payments one interoperable route across mobile apps, ATMs, USSD, branches and agents.

VALUE OF DIGITAL FINANCIAL TRANSACTIONS

- **Digital Finance Surge Marks Turning Point for Ethiopian Banking Sector: NBE** — Ethiopian News Agency, 1 October 2026

  33 trillion birr in digital transactions in FY2025/26; NBE pairs growth with cybersecurity and data-protection demands.

- **High Digital Transaction Costs, Fraud Gaps Threaten Ethiopia's Financial Inclusion Targets: Report** — The Reporter, 3 October 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

VISA AND ETTA CONTACTLESS ACCEPTANCE DEVICE ROLLOUT

- **Ethiopia's commerce goes contactless with new Visa and ETTA infrastructure agreement** — Capital Newspaper (Ethiopia), 7 October 2026

  148,000 tap-to-pay devices, tax-certified for e-receipts; merchant data feeds Optasia credit profiles; no sum stated.

INTERNATIONAL PAYMENT CARD ISSUANCE BY DOMESTIC BANKS

- **Banks Race to Launch International Payment Cards as Forex Reforms Open New Market** — Birr Metrics, 9 October 2026

  Awash-Mastercard five cards, Oromia-Visa three, 8 Oct 2026; NBE's Feb 2026 easing; card use still capped by forex.

Sectoral management information systems

INTEGRATED TAX ADMINISTRATION SYSTEM (ITAS)

- **Re-advertisement: Request for Expressions of Interest - Selection of Technical Lead/Chief Architect for the Integrated Tax Administration System (ITAS)** — Ministry of Revenue (Ethiopia), via Get Chereta, 8 October 2026

  World Bank-funded architect to govern ITAS design, vendors and e-invoicing integration; EOIs due 29 Oct 2026.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

COMMODITY EXCHANGE DIGITAL SERVICE PORTAL

- **ECX Launches Digital Portal to Cut Red Tape for Traders** — Capital (Ethiopia), 6 September 2026

  Built in-house; a 30-minute SLA replaces trips to offices that drew 150+ visitors a day in peak season.

STATE LOGISTICS SELF-SERVICE PLATFORMS

- **Digital logistics overhaul aims to boost regional trade competitiveness** — Capital Newspaper, 13 September 2026

  ESL launched an all-in-one self-service platform on 2026-09-04; EDR added its own cargo portal.

Inclusion

Access to services

OPERATOR FOUNDATION MEMORANDUM ON DISABILITY INCLUSION

- **Safaricom Ethiopia Foundation and FEAPD Sign Three-Year Pact to Advance Disability Inclusion** — Tech Africa News, 1 September 2026

  Three-year MoU covers accessible tech, education and healthcare for Ethiopians with disabilities.

SMARTPHONE AFFORDABILITY FINANCING

- **Ethio Telecom Secures 15bln Birr Siinqee Bank Deal To Fund Smartphone Access Drive** — Birr Metrics, 3 September 2026

15bn birr Siinqee Bank facility, 4bn earmarked for low-income smartphone buyers; penetration about 36%.

WOMEN TRADERS PROGRAMME ON THE DJIBOUTI CORRIDOR

- **From export readiness to market access: EU-backed support strengthens women's participation in trade along the Djibouti-Ethiopia Corridor** — Horn Economic Review, 3 September 2026 DJIBOUTI

  40 women traders at Bishoftu, 30-31 Jul 2026, under the EUR 32m EU/AFD Djibouti Corridor programme; 94% unlicensed.

REFUGEE WOMEN'S SIM REGISTRATION AND MOBILE USE

- **Closing the digital divide for refugee women means understanding their full experience of connectivity** — GSMA Mobile for Humanitarian Innovation (Zainab Moallin), 10 September 2026 UGANDA TANZANIA MAURITANIA GLOBAL

  GSMA's own account: refugee women in Ethiopia twice as likely to hold SIMs in others' names; Mbera fieldwork.

Geopolitics

India activities

INDIA DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE LEARNING MISSION

- **Karnataka Hosts African Union, Five African Nations For Digital Public Infrastructure Exposure Visit** — The Bengaluru Live, 1 September 2026 MALAWI RWANDA SIERRA LEONE ZAMBIA

  AU plus Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia study Karnataka DPI; UNDP-supported.

- **African Delegations Explore India's Digital Public Infrastructure During UNDP Learning Mission** — Youth Village Zambia, 2 September 2026 ZAMBIA MALAWI RWANDA SIERRA LEONE

  Five African delegations tour Aadhaar, UPI and DigiLocker on a UNDP South-South mission.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-16**
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/ETH/ETH-monthly-2026-10-16.pdf
FEEDBACK	info@data-landscapers.io
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0